

SEPTEMBER 16 / SOURCE BRIEFING

Astra, then Projects

Two questions: what deserves the budget, and what work needs a coordinator?



ASTRA / THE BUDGET

Price the hard job first

The API card lists a flagship price band, not a promise of better results on every task.

Input / 1M tokens

\$10

Standard rate

Output / 1M tokens

\$50

Standard rate

Context window

1.05M

128K max output

ASTRA / THE LIMITS

Watch the long-context cliff

Above 272K input tokens, the higher rates apply to the full request.

Input + cache

2×

Above 272K input

Output

1.5×

Above 272K input

Fast mode

2×

Applicable Standard rates

PROJECTS / BETA SEPTEMBER 10

Coordinate work beyond one chat

Cursor describes a coordinator that directs subagents instead of writing code itself.

Execution

Cloud + local

Cloud by default

Continuity

Shared context

Files across agents

Subscriptions

Slack · PRs · CI

Or a schedule

PROJECTS / YOUR FIRST TEST

One project. One approval boundary.

Try a non-critical migration or documentation garden before handing over broader work.

Scope

One bounded job

Clear acceptance checks

Control

Review each merge

Keep send/pay/publish gates

Evidence

Your own result

PR claims are vendor-reported

SUPPORTING BOARD / PROVISIONAL

Check the price before the switch

Comparison charts and other release claims remain in the article for source review.

Prices

List or promo?

Check effective dates

Usage

Peak or cached?

Compare the same workload

Claims

Who measured it?

Vendor $\neq$ independent

LONGMONT AI / THIS WEEK

One hard job. One bounded Project.

Bring back the cost, the result, and the approval you kept.

